exist in plenty. Chinese references to 'ah san' are matched by Indian references to 'chinky' among even elite and educated Indians. It would be unusual to see Chinese nationals on Indian streets, but Indians from the North-East who are thought to look Chinese are routinely referred to as 'chinky' or 'chichi chu chu' (and asked if they are 'Chinese'). The Indian badminton star Jwala Gutta, whose father is Indian and whose mother is Chinese, recounts how in online forums she has been called 'China ka maal' ('made in China'), 'half Chinese' (why not half Indian?), and 'Chinki', especially when she is trolled. With the Covid-19 outbreak, she was called 'half Corona'.[82] During the early days of the outbreak, Indians from the North-East living in other parts of the country were yelled at and sometimes shunned for being associated with 'corona'.[83]

Liu Chuen Chen is a journalist with the *Indian Express* newspaper. She is Indian Chinese, born and raised in India. Early in the Covid-19 outbreak, as a regular customer she rushes to 'a familiar store for some purchase'. A member of the staff accosts her to 'pass some unpleasant remark and walk away'. Though he is forced to apologize by the store owner, Liu decides never to return to the shop. Soon afterwards, the Ladakh crisis blows up. Liu worries that she will have to prove she is not a spy. She recounts that when she tweeted 'something in favour of Indian Chinese', she was 'cornered for being a "Chinese agent" with a few people tagging the National Investigative Agency'. She accepts that most of the time she and others of the Indian Chinese community are 'treated with respect', but in times of conflict with China 'we are looked upon with suspicion'. She knows no Mandarin and speaks Hindi and Bengali, but someone suggests to her that she should 'wear more of ethnic clothes and wear a bindi to "prove" my nationality'. She wonders: 'Am I not just one of the 1.35 billion Indians out there? Why must minorities change culture to be seen as citizens?'[84]

As Jwala Gutta and Liu Chuen Chen saw and heard during the Covid-19 outbreak, everyday racism towards people who look Chinese is never very far away on Indian streets. The pandemic reinforced prevailing Indian attitudes not just towards Chinese-looking people, though; it also deepened